Topics Every
Data Engineer
Must Know 📌

Databricks Interview Guide

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Why Databricks Interviews Are Tricky

Databricks interviews test more than Spark syntax. They focus on architecture, performance, cost, and real-world decisions.

Spark Core Concepts

You must clearly understand:

Spark architecture (Driver, Executors) Executors)

Jobs, Stages, Tasks

Lazy evaluation

Transformations vs Actions

DataFrames & PySpark

Be strong in:

1. Joins & join strategies

2. Partitioning & repartition

3. Data skew & handling techniques

4. Caching & persistence

Delta Lake

Almost mandatory in interviews:

- **Delta vs Parquet**
- **ACID transactions**
- **OPTIMIZE & ZORDER**
- **VACUUM**
- **Schema enforcement vs evolution**

Databricks Clusters & Jobs

Interviewers expect clarity on:

1

Cluster types

2

Autoscaling & auto-termination

3

Job types & scheduling

4

Cost vs performance trade-offs

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Performance Optimization

You should be able to explain:

- **Shuffle reduction**
- **Broadcast joins**
- **Partition sizing**
- **File sizing (small file problem)**
- **Caching strategy**

Security & Integration

Often asked in senior roles:

1

Unity Catalog basics

2

Access control

3

ADLS integration

4

Secrets & Key Vault

5

ADF ↔ Databricks integration

Strong fundamentals = confident Databricks interviews.

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📌 Check my profile for deep dives on Spark, Delta Lake, and optimization.

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